The Vedic Period

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📍 **Topic: The Vedic Period & Sources of Information** 📌

- 🧠 **High-Yield Fact Table:**

Term / Category 🏷️	**Direct Fact / Detail** 📝
Veda	Derived from Sanskrit word 'vid' (meaning knowledge).
Shruti	Vedic literature revealed to sages by God; passed on orally from generation to generation.
Smriti	Vedic literature composed by Rishis.
Early Vedic Texts	(1500-1000 BCE) When most of the hymns of the Rig Veda were composed.
Later Vedic Texts	(1000-500 BCE) Remaining Vedas and their branches (Brahmanas, Aranyakas, Upanishads, etc.).
Rig Veda	Oldest religious text ("First Testament of Mankind"); 10 mandalas; contains Gayatri Mantra.
Sama Veda	'Sama' = Sweet Song/melody; hymns meant to be sung at sacrifice by priests.
Yajur Veda	Hymns recited during Yajnas; two recensions: Black (Krishna) and White (Shukla).

Term / Category 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Atharva Veda	Magic/charms to ward off evil/diseases; covers *gyan* (knowledge), *karma* (action), *upasana* (invocation).

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - **Arrival & Settlement:** Scholars/historians refer to period when Aryans first settled in India as Early Vedic Period (1500-1000 BCE) ➔ between 1000 BCE to 500 BCE iron came to be used ➔ Aryans followed course of rivers and settled along valley of Yamuna and Ganga ➔ iron tools helped clear forests ➔ moved in eastward and south-eastward direction ➔ gradually settled in Gangetic valley (Later Vedic Age: 1000-500 BCE) ➔ culture referred to as Vedic culture because it was based on Vedic texts ➔ Literary sources divided into two broad chronological groups ➔ Early Vedic texts (1500-1000 BCE) when most hymns of Rig Veda were composed ➔ Later Vedic texts (1000-500 BCE) to which belong remaining Vedas and their branches (Brahmanas, Aranyakas, Upanishads, etc.) ➔ two periods correspond to two phases of Aryan expansion in India ➔ Vedic literature written in Sanskrit ➔ term 'Veda' derived from Sanskrit word 'vid' meaning knowledge ➔ Vedic literature divided into two parts: Shruti and Smriti ➔ believed Shruti was revealed to sages by God and passed on orally from generation to generation ➔ Smriti literature composed by Rishis. ⚔️
    - **The Rig Veda:** Rig Veda is oldest religious text in world ➔ therefore known as "First Testament of Mankind" ➔ divided into 10 mandalas ➔ said to have been composed during Early Vedic Period ➔ hence depict life of Early Vedic people in India ➔ hymns are dedicated by the sages to Gods ➔ they were passed on orally from teachers to their disciples ➔ Rig Vedic hymns are authentic sources of knowledge of life of people of the time ➔ much of Indian philosophy is based on the Rig Veda ➔ also contains famous

'Gayatri Mantra' ➔ Rig Veda included by UNESCO in list of literature signifying World Human Heritage. 📜

- **The Sama Veda & Yajur Veda:** Sama Veda term 'Sama' means 'Sweet Song' or 'the melody' ➔ some hymns are borrowed from Rig Veda ➔ hymns in Sama Veda meant to be sung at time of sacrifice by priests ➔ Yajur Veda deals with hymns recited during performance of Yajnas ➔ found in two recensions: Black (Krishna Yajur Veda) and White (Shukla Yajur Veda) ➔ full of rituals to be performed publicly or individually ➔ hymns throw light on social and religious life of Aryans. 🎶🔥
- **The Atharva Veda & Importance of Vedas:** Atharva Veda hymns deal with magic and charm to ward off evil spirits and diseases ➔ most hymns taken from Rig Veda ➔ besides powers of spirits, hymns deal with gyan (knowledge), karma (action), upasana (invocation) ➔ some hymns also deal with medicines for treatment of various diseases ➔ Importance of Vedas: storehouse of knowledge about Vedic Age ➔ social, economic, political, religious aspects of life reflected in Vedic literature ➔ although religious in nature, Vedas are valuable source of information on various subjects like music, medicine, history, philosophy, grammar, metrics, astronomy, art and architecture ➔ information all the more important in absence of any other material remains for giving glimpse of Vedic Age. 📚✨

📍 **Topic: The Epics (Ramayana & Mahabharata)** 📌

- 🧠 **High-Yield Fact Table:**

Term / Category 🏷️	**Direct Fact / Detail** 📝
Ramayana	Epic poetry originally composed in Sanskrit by Maharishi Valmiki.

Term / Category 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Mahabharata	Epic poetry by sage Vyasa; originally called *Jaya* (victory), then *Bharata*.
Bhagwad Gita	Part of Mahabharata (Krishna's discourse); teaches the soul is immortal.
Kaushalya	Eldest queen of King Dashratha; mother of Rama.

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - **The Ramayana:** Ramayana and Mahabharata are important epics ➔ Ramayana originally composed in Sanskrit ➔ Sanskrit version said to be work of Maharishi Valmiki ➔ story revolves around Rama and abduction of his wife Sita by demon king Ravana ➔ battle between Rama and Ravana, duty, devotion and love shown by brothers is told in detail ➔ Rama was eldest of four sons of Dashratha (ruler of Ayodhya who had three queens) ➔ Rama was son of eldest queen Kaushalya and was heir-apparent to throne ➔ after Rama married Sita, he was to be installed as king ➔ at this juncture, other queen Kaikeyi reminded king of earlier promise to grant a wish ➔ Kaikeyi wanted son Bharata to be king and Rama sent into exile for 14 years ➔ Rama along with wife Sita and brother Lakshmana went into exile to forest ➔ in disguise of sanyasi, Ravana (demon king) abducted Sita and took her to Lanka ➔ Rama took help of Sugriva and Hanuman ➔ crossed ocean and defeated Ravana ➔ Rama, Sita, Lakshmana proceeded home having completed 14 years exile ➔ crowned the king. 🏹
    - **The Mahabharata:** Believed to be work of sage Vyasa, written in Sanskrit ➔ originally called *Jaya* or collection dealing with victory ➔ subsequently known as *Bharata* because it contains stories of descendants of one of earliest Vedic tribes called Bharat ➔ final compilation came to be known as Mahabharata ➔ King of

Hastinapur Dhritarashtra had 100 sons known as Kauravas ➔ brother Pandu who died earlier had 5 sons known as Pandavas ➔ in course of time, Dhritarashtra named eldest Pandava Yudhishthira his successor ➔ this angered Duryodhana (eldest of Kauravas) ➔ became cause of enmity and jealousy between cousins ➔ once during game of dice, Yudhishthira lost his kingdom as well as wife Draupadi to Duryodhana ➔ in accordance with agreement, Pandavas had to go into exile ➔ after completion of exile, Pandavas asked Kauravas to return kingdom but Duryodhana refused to give anything ➔ so war known as Mahabharata followed ➔ Mahabharata war lasted 18 days ➔ all Kaurava brothers were killed and Yudhishthira became ruler of Hastinapur. 🛡️

- **Bhagwad Gita & Importance of Epics:** Arjuna (a Pandava) was reluctant to fight ➔ Krishna ultimately gave discourse and prevailed upon him to do his duty ➔ discourse at battlefield compiled in form of Bhagwad Gita ➔ forms part of Mahabharata ➔ one of the most popular religious texts considered sacred by many people in India ➔ the interests of the self might conflict with duty and whenever there is such a conflict the Bhagwad Gita gives the answer ➔ that is the secret of the undying popularity of this religious text ➔ it teaches that the Soul is immortal ➔ Importance of Epics: serve as main source of information on political institutions and social/cultural organisation of Epic Age ➔ provide information on various Aryan kingdoms, their armies and weapons used ➔ Kshatriyas entrusted with defence of kingdoms and believed death on battlefield was noblest act in life of warrior ➔ Epics considered finest literary works of ancient period ➔ acclaimed for literary and philosophical value ➔ reveal high ideals of family life of Aryans ➔ heroes of Epics are embodiment of high moral principles ➔ made significant impact on successive generations. 👑🕊️

📍 EARLY VEDIC PERIOD 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**

- During Early Vedic Period settlements mainly located in north-western part of Indian subcontinent ➔ Based on names of rivers and mountains in Rig Veda believed Aryans entered India from Afghanistan ➔ Settled in valley of Kabul river and Punjab ➔ Called this north-western part Sapta Sindhu or land of seven rivers ➔ Namely Sindhu (Indus), Parushni (Ravi), Vipash (Beas), Shutudri (Satluj), Vitasta (Jhelum), Askini (Chenab), Saraswati ➔ Region covers present areas of eastern Afghanistan, Punjab, and parts of Western Uttar Pradesh ➔ Later this region was named Brahmavarta or land of the Gods ➔ Because composition of Rig Veda took place here on banks of river Saraswati (considered most sacred). 🏞️

📍 **SOCIAL ORGANISATION: Family** 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
  - In Rig Vedic time or Early Vedic Period Aryans lived in villages ➔ Family was fundamental unit of society ➔ It was patriarchal ➔ Oldest male member of family was its head ➔ Called Grihapati or Kulapa ➔ After death of Grihapati responsibility shifted to eldest son ➔ Marriages took place after boy and girl attained maturity ➔ Monogamy was usual norm though chiefs practiced polygamy ➔ Several families lived in a grama or village ➔ Several villages formed a Visha ➔ Many Vishas formed a Jana ➔ Head of village called Gramini ➔ Head of Visha called Vishapati ➔ Rajan or king was head of a Jana. 👨‍👨‍👦

📍 **Position of the King** 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
  - Kings governed with help of ministers ➔ Important officers included Gramini, Purohita, Senani ➔ Senani was commander of army ➔ Purohita performed religious ceremonies ➔ Administration of villages carried out by Gramini ➔ King did not maintain any regular army ➔ In times of war organised tribal groups to perform military functions ➔ During Rig Vedic time tribe elected leader of its own ➔ Not as powerful as one in Later Vedic Period ➔ In Later

Vedic Age kingship became hereditary ➔ Divine elements came to be associated with king ➔ Elaborate coronation rituals such as Vajapeya and Rajasuya established king as chief authority ➔ Period marked beginning of taxation system and administrative machinery ➔ Taxes called Bali, Shulka, Bhaga offered by people to king. 👑

📍 Rig Vedic Assemblies 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - In Rig Vedic Period three popular assemblies advised the king ➔ Sabha, Samiti, Vidatha ➔ Vidatha was earliest assembly ➔ Performed all kinds of functions: economic, military, religious, social ➔ Women actively participated in deliberations in Vidatha ➔ Sabha was council of elders ➔ Performed advisory and judicial functions ➔ Samiti called to session on special occasions ➔ During Later Vedic Age Sabha and Samiti came to be dominated by chiefs and rich nobles ➔ Officers appointed to help kings in administration usurped function of popular assemblies as main advisors ➔ Authority of popular assemblies started waning ➔ Gradually lost their earlier importance. 🏛️

📍 POSITION OF WOMEN 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - During Rig Vedic Period women enjoyed respectable position and relatively high status ➔ Practice of child marriage did not exist ➔ Girls able to study and education given due importance ➔ Upanayana (initiation ceremony) organised for both girls and boys ➔ Educated women called Brahmavadinis (speakers/revealers of Brahman, infinite source of spirituality) ➔ Rig Veda contains hymns composed by 27 women seers (Ghosha, Vishwavara, Apala, Gargi, Maitreyi, Lopamudra) ➔ Institution of marriage became sacred ➔ Marriageable age was 16 to 17 ➔ Daughters given freedom to choose husbands ➔ Given place of honour as they participated in religious ceremonies with husbands ➔ No religious rites/rituals could be performed by man without wife ➔ System of remarriage of widows prevalent ➔ Could take part in proceedings of Sabha and

Samiti ➔ In Later Vedic Period significant decline in status of women ➔ Not allowed right of Upanayana ➔ Upper classes given access to education but universal access diminished ➔ Participation in Yajnas/rituals not considered necessary ➔ Did not enjoy right to property ➔ Freedom to choose husbands curtailed ➔ No longer permitted to attend tribal assemblies. 🙅‍♀️

📍 ECONOMY 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Rig Vedic economy primarily pastoral ➔ Cattle synonymous with wealth ➔ Wealthy person called gomat ➔ Gopa and gopati were epithets given to king ➔ Godhuli used as term for measure of time ➔ Distance called gavyuti ➔ Daughter called duhitr (one who milks the cows) ➔ Agricultural activities find very few references compared to linguistic evidence for cattle rearing ➔ Apart from yava (barley) no other grains mentioned ➔ References to fire used for burning forest cover and shifting cultivation ➔ Area received low rainfall ➔ Major rivers changed courses frequently ➔ Alluvial lands near rivers could not be cultivated on permanent basis ➔ Major changes in economy took place during Later Vedic phase ➔ Importance of agriculture grew ➔ Made possible by availability of vast tracts of fertile alluvial lands of Ganga-Yamuna doab and middle Ganga valley ➔ Archaeological and literary sources depict introduction of rice as staple diet ➔ Vedic texts mention Vrihi, Tandula, Sali denoting rice ➔ Texts refer to oxen yoked to plough suggesting prevalence of plough cultivation ➔ Towards end of period iron ploughshares and metal tools used ➔ Variety of crops cultivated. 🌾🐄

🧠 1. High-Yield Fact Table 📌

Term / Location 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Sapta Sindhu	Land of seven rivers (Sindhu, Parushni, Vipash, Shutudri, Vitasta, Askini, Saraswati).

Term / Location 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Brahmavarta	Land of the Gods; the banks of river Saraswati where Rig Veda composition took place.
Grihapati / Kulapa	Oldest male member and head of the patriarchal family.
Gramini / Vishapati / Rajan	Heads of the village (grama), Visha, and Jana, respectively.
Senani & Purohita	Commander of the army and performer of religious ceremonies.
Vajapeya & Rajasuya	Elaborate coronation rituals establishing the king's chief authority in Later Vedic Age.
Bali, Shulka, Bhaga	Taxes offered by the people to the king.
Brahmavadinis	Educated women; speakers/revealers of Brahman (infinite source of spirituality).
Gomat / Gopa / Gopati	A wealthy person / Epithets given to the king.
Godhuli / Gavyuti / Duhitr	Measure of time / Measure of distance / Daughter ("one who milks cows").
Yava	Barley; the only grain mentioned in the Rig Veda.
Vrihi, Tandula, Sali	Terms denoting rice in the Later Vedic texts.

🧠 2. Comparative Study of Society in Early and Later Vedic Period 📌

Basis of Comparison	Early Vedic Age	Later Vedic Age
Family	Family was the basic unit.	Joint Family System prevailed.
Women	Women enjoyed equal rights.	Significant decline in status of women.
Caste system	Rigid caste system did not prevail.	The caste system was becoming rigid / further enlarged.
Education	-	Gurukul system of education.

🧠 **3. Comparative Study of the Position of Women in Early and Later Vedic Society** 📌

Basis of Comparison	Early Vedic Age	Later Vedic Age
Social Status	Women enjoyed a respectable and relatively high status in society.	This period saw a significant decline in the status of women in society compared to Early Age.
Education	Women were entitled to the Upanayana ceremony and given education. Many educated women, called Brahmavadinis composed hymns and were well-versed in sacred texts.	They were denied the right of Upanayana. Education was available to upper-class women, whereas universal access diminished. Brahmavadinis existed during the Later Vedic Age and had access to spiritual knowledge.

Basis of Comparison	Early Vedic Age	Later Vedic Age
Marriage	Women had the freedom to choose their husbands. Widows could remarry. Child-marriage and Sati did not exist.	The right of the women to choose their husbands was curtailed. Child-marriage and Sati system.
Religious Role	Women actively participated in Yajnas and religious rituals. No religious rites and rituals could be performed by a man without his wife.	The privilege of participation in Vedic rites with husband was snatched away from the women.
Political Rights	Women could take part in the proceedings of the tribal assemblies like the Sabha and the Samiti.	Women were not permitted to attend the tribal assemblies.

🧠 1. High-Yield Fact Table 📌

Term / Category 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Charmakaras	Leather workers mentioned in Vedic texts.
Rathakaras	Wheelwrights mentioned in Vedic texts.
Kulala	Potters mentioned in Vedic texts.
Taksan	Carpenters mentioned in Vedic texts.

Term / Category 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Soma	An intoxicating drink consumed during festivals and religious ceremonies.
Nivi	An undergarment or dhoti worn by the people.
Vasa	An upper piece of clothing or shirt.
Adhivasa	An overgarment made of a loose piece of cloth.
Mrigchala	Deer skin worn by sadhus (hermits).
Varnas	The four distinct castes: Brahmins, Kshatriyas, Vaishyas, and Shudras.
Upanayana	Investiture with the sacred thread (only the top three varnas were entitled to it).
Moksha	Salvation, attained during the Sanyasa ashrama through meditation.
Gurukul	The residence of the guru; means "family of the guru"; the most sacred institution of education.
Guru Dakshina	A gift given to the teacher by the student upon completion of education.
Maitreyi & Gargi	Two gifted and greatly respected women teachers of the Vedic period.

🧠 2. Comparison between the Economy of Early and Later Vedic Period 📌

Aspect	Early Vedic Age (c. 1500–1000 BCE)	Later Vedic Age (c. 1000–600 BCE)
Nature of Economy	In the beginning the main occupation was domestication of animals and agriculture was secondary.	Agriculture became the chief occupation while domestication of animals also continued.
Main Occupation	Cattle was the important source of wealth.	Land was the important source of wealth.
Importance of Cattle	Cattle was synonymous with wealth; wealth measured in cows.	Still important but secondary to land.
Agriculture	Limited and primitive; barley (yava) as the only grain. Shifting cultivation practiced.	Agriculture was well-developed; wheat, barley were main grains. Plough cultivation practiced rice.
Crafts and Occupations	Many engaged in trade and commerce. Dyeing, embroidery, carpentry, weaving, pottery, crafts in gold and iron were important occupations.	Traders guilds had come up and trade had become very important. Besides occupations of earlier period, new occupations like physicians, musicians, and many other professions emerged.
Trade and Commerce	Barter system; limited local exchange.	Trade expanded; beginning of long-distance trade.

Aspect	Early Vedic Age (c. 1500–1000 BCE)	Later Vedic Age (c. 1000–600 BCE)
Use of Iron	Almost absent.	Extensive use of iron tools (ploughs, axes).
Surplus Production	Minimal surplus.	Increased surplus due to settled farming.
Taxes and Revenue	No regular taxation.	Taxes like *bali*, *shulka* and *bhaga* offered by the people to the king.

📍 **CRAFTS, OCCUPATIONS & TRADE** 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Craftsmen mentioned in Vedic texts include leather workers (charmakaras), wheelwrights (rathakaras), blacksmiths, potters (kulala), carpenters (taksan) ➔ none of these groups considered of low status ➔ weaving seems to have been domestic craft ➔ wool obtained from sheep was most common raw material ➔ cotton is not mentioned ➔ Trade: During Later Vedic phase increased agricultural surplus from settled farming led to trade ➔ people began to specialise in different crafts ➔ creating need for market centres to exchange goods ➔ fostered growth of urban settlements along major river valleys like the Ganges ➔ trade routes converged with urban settlements ➔ resulting in emergence of towns and cities ➔ growing population of artisans, merchants and administrators ➔ trade became pivot around which whole town and city life moved ➔ Aryans had introduced coins but barter system still dominant in trade with other countries ➔ Occupations: Besides agriculture and trade, occupations included domestication of animals, crafts in various metals, carpentry, pottery, fishery ➔ Women were engaged in spinning, weaving, knitting and dyeing. 🛠️🤝

📍 FOOD, DRESS AND AMUSEMENTS 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Main cereal produced by Rig Vedic people was barley ➔ wheat and rice were not known to them ➔ Later Vedic times show evidence of using rice (vrihi) ➔ cows were domesticated ➔ milk and milk products like curd, butter, ghee were used ➔ Soma (intoxicating drink) consumed during festivals and religious ceremonies ➔ Dress: Clothes worn were simple ➔ consisted of undergarment called Nivi or dhoti ➔ upper piece called Vasa or shirt ➔ overgarment known as Adhivasa (loose piece of cloth) ➔ men wore turbans ➔ customs of wearing animal skins ➔ sadhus (hermits) wore deer skin known as Mrigchala ➔ men kept long hair ➔ Ornaments: Worn by both men and women ➔ made of gold, silver, ivory and precious stones ➔ common items were earrings, rings, anklets, bracelets, necklaces ➔ Amusements: Main means of amusement in both Vedic periods were chariot-races, horse-races, dancing, singing and hunting ➔ chief musical instruments were drum, flute, mridang and lute ➔ people participated in competitive sports, festivals and gambling. 🌾👗🎲

📍 THE FOUR CLASS DIVISIONS 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Caste system not mentioned in Rig Veda ➔ some kind of class division existed ➔ tribal chiefs and priests acquired large share of booty ➔ grew at cost of their kinsmen ➔ resulted in social inequalities ➔ tribal society divided into three groups: warriors, priests and the people ➔ Early Vedic Period society divided into classes based on profession and not birth ➔ person could adopt any profession of his choice (evident from excerpt: poet, physician, corn-grinding mother in same family) ➔ people followed different professions which became hereditary in course of time ➔ resulted in division of society into occupational classes ➔ gradually took form of caste ➔ present caste system emerged in Later Vedic Period ➔ Brahmins, Kshatriyas, Vaishyas and Shudras became four distinct castes or Varnas ➔ Brahmins/priests performed religious rituals ➔ Kshatriyas participated in wars ➔ Vaishyas engaged in

business, agriculture, industry ➔ Shudras served upper classes ➔ fourth division (Shudras) appeared towards end of Rig Vedic period ➔ word 'shudra' mentioned for first time in Tenth Mandala (considered later addition) ➔ Early economy mainly pastoral and not food producing so no scope for collecting regular tributes/taxes ➔ Later Vedic Age caste system became rigid ➔ Brahmins and Kshatriyas enjoyed many privileges ➔ priests considered as gods on earth ➔ Kshatriyas increased power and regarded as ruling class ➔ all three higher varnas entitled to upanayana or investiture with sacred thread according to Vedic mantras ➔ Inter-caste marriage not prevalent. ⚖️ 👑

📍 THE FOUR ASHRAMAS 📌

- 🗺️ ➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Early Vedic Period man grew up according to family traditions ➔ Later Vedic Period whole lifespan of Aryan divided into four periods ➔ four stages of life known as four ashramas ➔ each of 25 years duration ➔ Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha and Sanyasa ➔ Brahmacharya Ashrama lasted up to age of 25 years ➔ pupil expected to acquire knowledge in gurukul and observe strict discipline ➔ Grihastha Ashrama man was supposed to marry and raise a family ➔ as householder was to take responsibility of maintaining his family ➔ lasted from age 25 to 50 years ➔ Vanaprastha Ashrama lasted from age 50 to 75 years ➔ expected to retire from worldly life ➔ acquire spiritual and philosophical knowledge ➔ Sanyasa Ashrama lasted from age 75 to 100 years ➔ period of renunciation ➔ man had to leave everything forever ➔ go into meditation in order to attain moksha or salvation. ⏳ 🧘

📍 EDUCATION SYSTEM 📌

- 🗺️ ➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Education imparted through private gurukuls ➔ residence of the guru called the gurukul ➔ meaning the family of the guru ➔ had become most sacred institution ➔ gurukuls often located on outskirts of city and even in forests ➔ students lived there ➔

Guru treated students like his own children ➔ student required to do household chores for teacher ➔ had to wake up early in the morning, take a bath and chant Vedic mantras ➔ most teaching was done orally ➔ at completion of education student used to give guru dakshina (gift to teacher) ➔ gurus were greatly respected and revered ➔ main objective of education was to bring about physical, mental and spiritual development of pupils ➔ subjects of study included Vedas, Puranas, grammar, mathematics, ethics, logic and military science ➔ Two women teachers named Maitreyi and Gargi were considered gifted and greatly respected. 📖 🙏